

Because motorcyclists must take additional precautions when they come upon special highway surfaces, you should know what a motorcyclist may do:

- The motorcyclist may quickly change speed or lane position to avoid loose gravel, debris, seams or grooves in the pavement, sewer or access covers or small animals.
- When approaching a railroad crossing, a motorcyclist may decrease speed and rise off the seat to cushion the rough crossing and change direction to go across the tracks at a right angle.
- On steel deck bridges the motorcyclist may move to the center of the lane to adjust for the surface that is not even. Stay a good distance behind a motorcyclist in this situation.

Drivers need to adjust how they drive around motorcycles.

- Don't tailgate. Motorcycles can stop in a shorter distance than cars – under the right conditions. Also, it may be more difficult to notice they are slowing or stopping.
- If it's raining, or dark, give motorcycles even more space.
- Be careful when you pass a motorcyclist. Like bicycles, the air pressure created by vehicles as they quickly pass by can affect motorcycles.

## MOPED OPERATORS

Limited use motorcycles, often called mopeds, are low speed, two- or three-wheeled vehicles for limited use on public highways. There are three different classes of mopeds based on maximum performance speed. The chart below describes the requirements for moped operation.

| Class                                                        | A                           | B                                        | C                                        |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------|
| Top speed range mph (km/hr)                                  | 31 to 40<br>(over 48 to 64) | 21 to 30<br>(32 to 48)                   | 20 or less<br>(32 or less)               |
| Type of license or learner permit required <sup>4</sup>      | M                           | ANY CLASS <sup>4</sup>                   | ANY CLASS <sup>4</sup>                   |
| Registration required                                        | YES (A Plate)               | YES (B Plate)                            | YES (C Plate)                            |
| Headlight to be on when operating                            | YES                         | YES                                      | YES                                      |
| Helmet & eye protection required when operating <sup>5</sup> | YES                         | YES                                      | Recommended                              |
| Where operation is permitted                                 | Any Traffic Lane & Shoulder | Right Hand Lane or Shoulder <sup>1</sup> | Right Hand Lane or Shoulder <sup>1</sup> |
| Mandatory insurance required                                 | YES                         | YES                                      | Recommended <sup>2</sup>                 |
| Safety responsibility applies <sup>3</sup>                   | YES                         | YES                                      | YES                                      |
| Annual inspection required                                   | YES                         | Recommended                              | Recommended                              |
| Title required                                               | NO                          | NO                                       | NO                                       |

<sup>1</sup> Except when making a left hand turn

<sup>2</sup> If a Class C limited use motorcycle is used in a rental business, insurance is mandatory.

<sup>3</sup> Safety responsibility is the requirement to pay for or post security for damage or personal injury you may cause in a traffic crash.

<sup>4</sup> Usual learner permit and junior license restrictions apply.

<sup>5</sup> least four square inches of reflective material on both sides. Motorcyclists must also wear approved eye protection, even if the motorcycle is equipped with a windshield. Prescription or made-to-order safety glasses may be used if the user can present written certification that they meet DMV standards. The eye protection must be manufactured in conformity with the regulations issued by the Vehicle Equipment Safety Commission (VESC-8).